

ALLITERATION

Repeating the same starting sound in nearby words



1 What is it?

Alliteration (uh-lit-uh-RAY-shun)

Alliteration repeats the **same consonant sound** at the start of several words close together, creating a rhythm the reader can hear.

Same + Sound + Start

2 See it in action

In a headline

Big Bad Wolf Battles Brave Builders.

In poetry

The wild wind whispered through the willow trees.

In branding

Coca-Cola, PayPal, and Dunkin' Donuts all use alliteration in their names.

For emphasis

She sold seashells by the seashore, steady and swift.



Good spot!

Say the phrase **out loud** — your ear will catch alliteration far quicker than your eye will, especially with tricky spellings.

FUN FACT

Alliteration is why so many superhero names stick in your head: Peter Parker, Wonder Woman, and Lois Lane are all alliterative — it's a trick writers have used for centuries to make names unforgettable.

3 Why writers use it

Alliteration helps writers: create rhythm and musicality, make phrases more memorable (great for titles, slogans and headlines), and can speed up or slow down how a sentence feels when read aloud.

Repeated hard sounds (like **B** or **K**) can feel aggressive or punchy, while soft sounds (like **W** or **S**) can feel gentle or soothing – the sound itself adds meaning.

4 Don't mix it up!

Alliteration

- Same sound at the **start** of words
- "Big bad bear"
- About consonant sounds

Sibilance

- A specific type of alliteration
- Only "**s**" or soft "sh" sounds
- "The **s**nake **s**lithered"



Watch out!

Alliteration is about **sound**, not spelling! "Kind Cat" alliterates (both start with a hard K sound) but "City Cat" does NOT – the C in "city" makes an S sound.



Keep going!

Once you spot alliteration, think about the **sound itself**: hard sounds like B/K/T feel sharp or aggressive, soft sounds like W/S/M feel gentle. That's your analysis point.

5 Quick recap

Repeats starting sounds

Creates rhythm

Makes phrases memorable



Mfalme says...

Challenge yourself to write a three-word alliterative phrase about your day – "Monday's Massive Mess" counts!